BRIGHTER DAYS COLLECTION

50+ Activities for Bedridden Seniors

Gentle, joyful activities to do in bed or in a wheelchair, no standing needed.



No standing needed

Calm the senses

Spark joy

10 minutes a day

BEFORE YOU START

HOW TO USE THIS BOOK



Every activity in this book was designed for loved ones who spend most of the day in bed or in a wheelchair.

NO STANDING NEEDED

Everything is done sitting up in bed, in a wheelchair or in an armchair.

ABOUT 10 MINUTES

Short, gentle sessions that fit any part of the day.



SIMPLE MATERIALS

Things you already have at home: a tray, a towel, a balloon, old photos.

FOR BODY, MIND AND HEART

Each page shows its focus: Memory, Senses, Movement, Calm, Social or Purpose.

SAFETY FIRST

- Sit them up at least halfway with pillows.
- Check for allergies before using scents, foods or balloons.
- Use only large items. Never leave small objects within reach.
- Watch their face: stop if they look tired or uncomfortable.



Follow their mood. A good activity is the one that brings a smile today.

ACTIVITY 01

BEDSIDE & CHAIR

THE MEMORY BOX

MEMORY

A box of little treasures that opens the door to **big stories.**



WHAT TO PUT INSIDE



Old photos



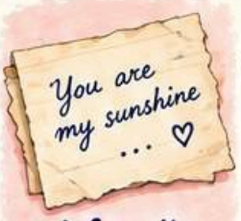
Postcards



A medal



Fabric scraps



A favorite song lyric



A recipe card

STEP BY STEP

1 FILL THE BOX
6 to 8 meaningful objects.



2 OPEN TOGETHER
One object at a time.



3 ASK
"Where is this from?"



4 LISTEN
Let the story take its time.



CAREGIVER TIP

Keep the box by the bed. It becomes a favorite ritual.

ACTIVITY 02

BEDSIDE & CHAIR

GUESS THE SCENT

SENSES

Close your eyes and let your nose bring back **the memories.**



SCENT JARS



Coffee · Cinnamon · Lemon · Lavender · Vanilla · Fresh mint

TALK ABOUT IT

Does this scent remind you of a place, a season, or a favorite recipe?

STEP BY STEP



1 PREPARE
Put a little of each scent in a jar.



2 SMELL
One jar at a time, eyes closed.



3 GUESS
Name the scent.



4 REMEMBER
"Where have you smelled this before?"

CAREGIVER TIP

Avoid strong perfumes and check for allergies.

ACTIVITY 03 BEDSIDE & CHAIR

BEDSIDE BALLOON TAP

MOVEMENT



Gentle arm movement and lots of laughter, **without leaving the bed.**

VARIATIONS



Count the taps out loud



Use only the left hand



Tap with a paper plate

STEP BY STEP



1 SIT UP
Pillows behind the back.



2 TAP
Keep the balloon in the air.



3 PASS
Tap it to a partner.



4 REST
Stop after 3 to 5 minutes.

CAREGIVER TIP

Check for latex allergies and clear the space around the bed.

ACTIVITY 04

BEDSIDE & CHAIR

GENTLE HAND MASSAGE

TOUCH & CALM



Warm hands, soft lotion and quiet music. Comfort you can feel.

STEP BY STEP

1 WARM UP

Rub lotion between your palms.



2 PALMS

Small circles with your thumbs.



3 FINGERS

Gently stroke each finger.



4 FINISH

Hold both hands for a moment.



CALM MUSIC

Play soft music in the background.



CAREGIVER TIP

Ask permission first and watch the face for comfort.

ACTIVITY 05 BEDSIDE & CHAIR

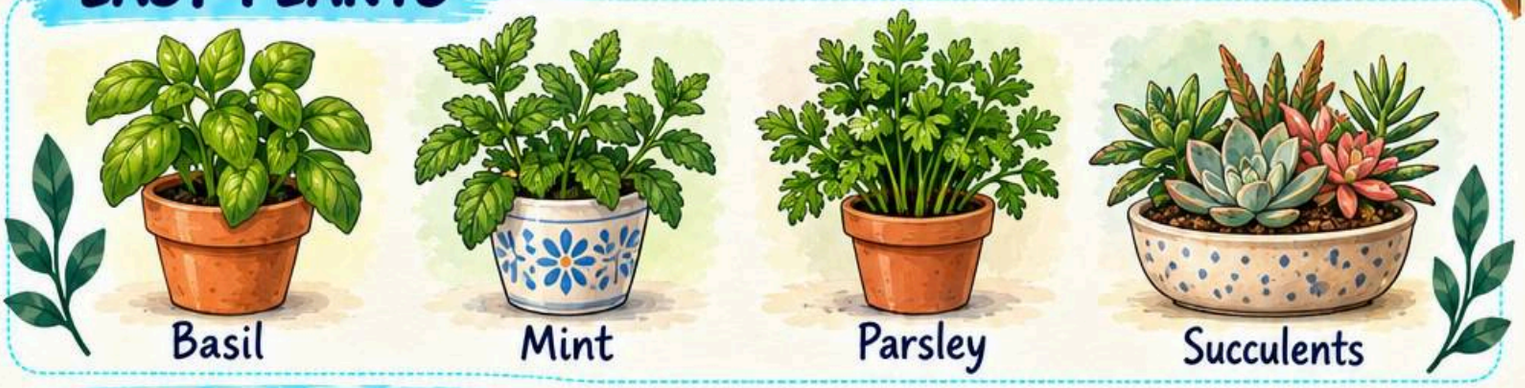
LAP TRAY GARDEN

NATURE

Soil on the fingers and something green to care for **every day.**



EASY PLANTS



Basil Mint Parsley Succulents

STEP BY STEP

1 SET THE TRAY
Cover it with newspaper.



2 FILL THE POT
A little soil at a time.



3 PLANT
Press the seedling in gently.



4 WATER
A small splash, then place it by the window.



CAREGIVER TIP

Use a deep tray so the soil stays in place.



ACTIVITY 06 BEDSIDE & CHAIR

SORT IT OUT

A calm, useful task that keeps the hands busy and the **mind focused.**



FOCUS

SORTING GAMES



Socks by color



Big buttons by size



Playing cards by suit

STEP BY STEP

1 POUR
Mix the items on the tray.



2 CHOOSE
Pick one way to sort.



3 SORT
One item at a time.



4 CELEBRATE
Count each bowl together.



CAREGIVER TIP

Use large items only. Never leave small items alone with someone who might swallow them.



ACTIVITY 07

BEDSIDE & CHAIR

BEDSIDE BINGO

SOCIAL

Big numbers, big smiles and a little friendly competition.



B	I	N	G	O
5	18	32	49	65
12	21	44	56	70
7	27	FREE	53	68
14	30	41	60	72
9	24	37	58	75

STEP BY STEP



STEP BY STEP

1 HAND OUT CARDS
Large print, one per player.



2 CALL
Say each number slowly, twice.



3 MARK
Use chips or a marker.



4 BINGO!
A small prize for every winner.

CAREGIVER TIP

Let the player call the numbers once in a while. They love it.

ACTIVITY 08

BEDSIDE & CHAIR

FOLDING TOGETHER

Feeling useful is one of the best medicines there is.



PURPOSE

WHAT TO FOLD



Washcloths



Small towels



Napkins



Pillowcases

STEP BY STEP

1 BRING THE BASKET
Warm laundry feels great.



2 SHOW ONCE
Fold one piece together.



3 FOLD
Let them work at their own pace.



4 THANK THEM
"You really helped me today."



CAREGIVER TIP

Never refold their work in front of them.



ACTIVITY 09 BEDSIDE & CHAIR

ARMCHAIR TRAVEL

IMAGINATION

Visit the world without leaving the room. ♡



TRIP IDEAS



Paris



Hawaii



The Grand Canyon



Italy

STEP BY STEP



1 PICK A PLACE
A dream trip or a place they once visited.



2 WATCH
A short video or photos on a tablet.



3 TASTE
A small snack from that place.



4 TALK
"Have you ever been there?"

CAREGIVER TIP

Add music from the country for the full experience.



ACTIVITY 10 BEDSIDE & CHAIR

BUSY BLANKET

SENSES

Restless hands find calm with buttons, zippers and soft textures.



BLANKET PARTS



Big buttons



A zipper



Ribbons to tie



A small pocket



Velcro strips



Soft fleece

STEP BY STEP



1 START
Use a small fleece blanket.



2 SEW ON
Add 6 safe, firmly attached items.



3 OFFER
Place it on the lap and let the hands explore.

CAREGIVER TIP

Check often that every item is sewn on tightly.

ACTIVITY 11

BEDSIDE & CHAIR

WHAT GOES TOGETHER?

Circle the word that goes best with the first one.



MEMORY

1	Cup →	saucer	shoe	tree
2	Salt →	pepper	cloud	chair
3	Bread →	butter	pencil	sock
4	Needle →	thread	lamp	apple
5	Key →	lock	spoon	bird
6	Rain →	umbrella	book	ring
7	Sock →	shoe	plate	star
8	Pillow →	bed	car	fork
9	Toothbrush →	toothpaste	hat	leaf
10	Pen →	paper	rock	drum

ANSWERS: saucer · pepper · butter · thread · lock · umbrella · shoe · bed · toothpaste · paper

ACTIVITY 12 BEDSIDE & CHAIR

STRETCH & BREATHE IN BED

A gentle routine to wake up the body in the morning or relax before sleep.



1 REACH UP
Arms slowly above the head.



2 SHOULDER ROLLS
Back and forward.



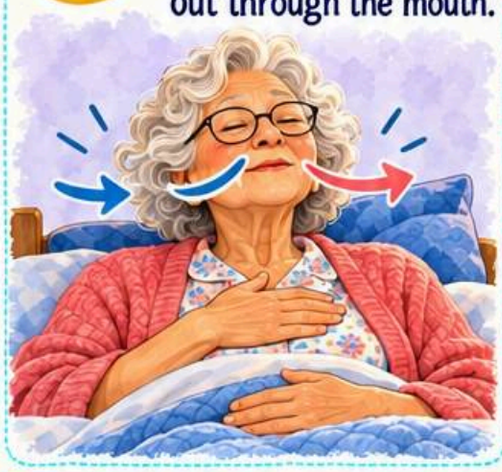
3 ANKLE CIRCLES
Under the blanket.



4 OPEN & CLOSE
Hands, 10 times.



5 DEEP BREATH
In through the nose, out through the mouth.



6 SMILE
A good day starts now.



CAREGIVER TIP Move slowly and stop if anything hurts. ♡

You've completed all 12 activities! ♡

ACTIVITY 13 BEDSIDE & CHAIR

PHOTO ALBUM STORIES

Every photo holds a story waiting to be told again.



PHOTO PROMPTS


Wedding day


First home


Old friends


Family trips

STEP BY STEP



1 CHOOSE AN ALBUM
Old photos work best.



2 TURN SLOWLY
One page at a time.



3 ASK
"Who is this?
Where were you?"



4 WRITE IT DOWN
Add names and dates on sticky notes.

CAREGIVER TIP

If a name won't come, say it gently and keep the story going.

ACTIVITY 14 BEDSIDE & CHAIR

LAP TRAY PAINTING

CREATIVITY

A splash of color, right on the lap. No skill needed, **just joy.**



EASY IDEAS



Sunflower



Blue sky



Rainbow



Heart

STEP BY STEP

1 **PROTECT**
A towel under the tray.



2 **WET**
A light swipe of water on the paper.



3 **PAINT**
Let the colors flow.



4 **DISPLAY**
Tape it on the wall by the bed.



CAREGIVER TIP

Use a cup with a wide base so it won't tip over.



ACTIVITY 15 BEDSIDE & CHAIR

MUSIC & MEMORIES

The songs of our youth stay with us the longest.



PLAYLIST BY DECADE

1940s: In the Mood



1950s: Blue Suede Shoes



1960s: My Girl



1970s: Dancing Queen



STEP BY STEP

1 PICK A DECADE
When they were 15 to 25.



2 PLAY IT
Headphones or a small speaker.



3 WATCH
Notice smiles, tapping, humming.



4 TALK
"Where were you when this song came out?"



CAREGIVER TIP

Keep the volume soft. Music should calm, not overwhelm.

ACTIVITY 16 BEDSIDE & CHAIR

SCARF DANCE IN BED

Gentle arm movement that feels like dancing.

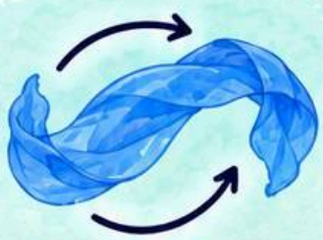


MOVEMENT

SCARF MOVES



Wave



Circle

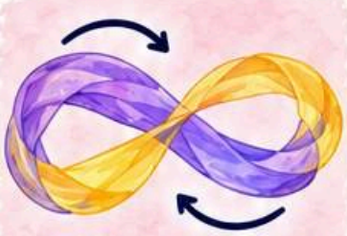


Figure eight



Toss & catch

STEP BY STEP

1 **PLAY MUSIC**
A slow waltz or a happy oldie.



2 **FOLLOW ME**
Copy each move together.



3 **REST**
Lower the arms after each song.



CAREGIVER TIP

Light silk or chiffon scarves are easy to lift and lovely to watch.



ACTIVITY 17

BEDSIDE & CHAIR

TREASURE TRAY

SENSES

Hands that explore, a mind that wakes up.



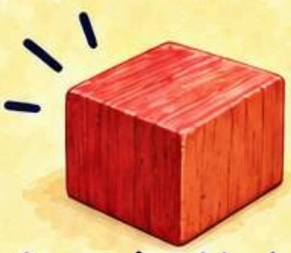
WHAT TO HIDE



A big key



A large spoon



A wooden block



A big button card

STEP BY STEP

1 FILL THE TRAY
Dry rice or dry beans.



2 HIDE
4 or 5 large objects.



3 FIND
Search with the fingers.



4 NAME IT
“What did you find?”



CAREGIVER TIP

Use only LARGE objects and stay close the whole time.

ACTIVITY 18

BEDSIDE & CHAIR

A SOFT COMPANION

Something soft to hold can bring calm in restless moments.



COMFORT TIPS



Choose a soft, washable plush



A realistic cat or dog works best



Never force it

STEP BY STEP

1 OFFER
Place the plush pet in their arms.



2 STROKE
Slow, gentle strokes on the fur.



3 TALK
Give it a name together.



4 REST
Let them keep it close for a nap.



CAREGIVER TIP

For some people, caring for a pet brings back a sense of purpose.

ACTIVITY 19 | BEDSIDE & CHAIR | SOCIAL

JUMBO CARD GAMES

Big cards, easy rules and lots of laughs.



JUMBO CARDS

Large-print cards are easy to see and hold.







STEP BY STEP

1 DEAL
5 jumbo cards each.



2 ASK
"Do you have a seven?"



3 MATCH
Lay down the pairs.



4 WIN
The most pairs wins!



CAREGIVER TIP

Use a card holder or a book stand so tired hands can rest.



ACTIVITY 20 | BEDSIDE & CHAIR | NATURE

WINDOW BIRD WATCH

A little bit of the outdoors, right from the bed.



BIRD CHECKLIST



- [ ] Cardinal



- [ ] Blue jay



- [ ] Robin



- [ ] Chickadee



- [ ] Goldfinch



- [ ] Hummingbird

STEP BY STEP



1 MOVE THE BED
Closer to the window, if possible.



2 WATCH
Count the visitors.



3 CHECK
Mark each bird you see.

CAREGIVER TIP

A feeder on the window glass brings birds very close.

ACTIVITY 21

BEDSIDE & CHAIR

MOVEMENT

SOFT BALL PASS

Reach, catch, pass. Gentle exercise that feels like a game.



GAME VARIATIONS

- Say a color as you pass
- Pass with one hand
- 1 2 3 Count together

STEP BY STEP



1 SIT FACING
Close enough to hand the ball.



2 PASS
Roll, toss or hand it over.



3 CATCH
Two hands are fine.



4 REST
After 5 minutes.

CAREGIVER TIP

A soft, light ball is safest. Never throw hard.

ACTIVITY 22 BEDSIDE & CHAIR

CARDS WITH LOVE



Making something for someone else feels wonderful.

STEP BY STEP



1 FOLD
A sheet of cardstock in half.



2 DECORATE
Stickers and flowers.



3 SIGN
A short message or just a name.



4 SEND
Mail it or give it in person.

CAREGIVER TIP

Pre-cut and pre-fold the cards to keep it easy.

ACTIVITY 23 BEDSIDE & CHAIR CALM

STORY TIME

A familiar voice and a good story: comfort for the whole afternoon.



GOOD THINGS TO READ



Short stories



Poems

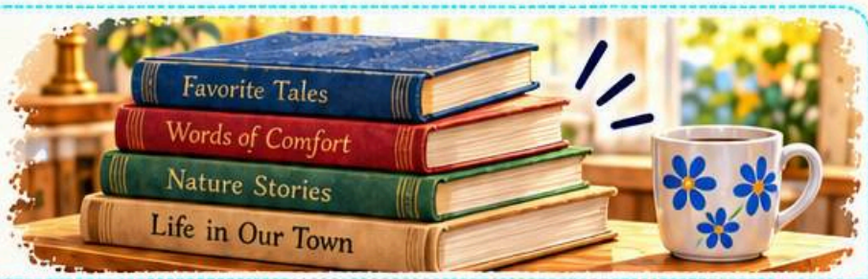


Old letters



The local newspaper

STEP BY STEP



1 CHOOSE
Something short and familiar.



2 READ SLOWLY
Pause and look up often.



3 TALK
"What did you think?"

CAREGIVER TIP

Read the same favorite story many times. Familiar is comforting.

ACTIVITY 24 | BEDSIDE & CHAIR | FOCUS

JUMBO PUZZLE

MEMORY & FOCUS

Big pieces, beautiful pictures and a proud moment at the end.

PUZZLE SIZES



6 pieces: easy



12 pieces: medium



24 pieces: challenge

STEP BY STEP



1 CHOOSE
A puzzle with a happy picture.



2 EDGES FIRST
Find the corner pieces.



3 BUILD
One piece at a time.



4 CELEBRATE
Take a photo of the finished puzzle.

CAREGIVER TIP

Use a tray with a rim so pieces don't fall.

ACTIVITY 25 BEDSIDE & CHAIR

TOUCH & MATCH

SENSES

Soft, rough, smooth: the hands remember what they feel.



FABRIC PAIRS



Velvet



Wool



Silk



Burlap



Cotton



Corduroy

STEP BY STEP

1 **CUT**
Two squares of each fabric.



2 **MIX**
Spread them on the tray.



3 **FEEL**
Eyes open or closed.



4 **MATCH**
Find the pairs.



CAREGIVER TIP

Talk about each fabric: “Did you have a velvet dress?”

ACTIVITY 26 BEDSIDE & CHAIR

TASTES OF HOME

A familiar flavor can open a whole box of memories.



TASTE & TALK


Apple pie spices


Orange


Chocolate


Cinnamon cookie

STEP BY STEP

1 CHECK
Diet and swallowing first.



2 TASTE
One small bite at a time.



3 GUESS
"What flavor is this?"



4 REMEMBER
"Who made this when you were little?"



CAREGIVER TIP

Always follow their diet and swallowing guidance.



ACTIVITY 27

BEDSIDE & CHAIR

SOCIAL

FAMILY VIDEO CALL

Far away, but right there on the screen.



CALL IDEAS



Show a drawing



Sing together

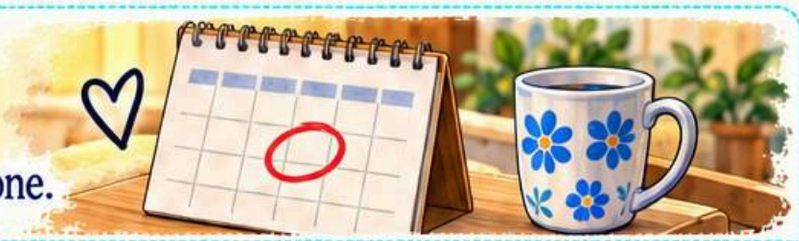


Show the garden



Tell a joke

STEP BY STEP



1 SCHEDULE
A time that works for everyone.



2 SET UP
Tablet on a stand, sound up.



3 CALL
Let the family lead at first.



4 SAY GOODBYE
Plan the next call.

CAREGIVER TIP

Short calls of 10 minutes are easier and more joyful.

ACTIVITY 28

BEDSIDE & CHAIR

SING-ALONG HOUR

MUSIC

Voices together, hearts lifted.
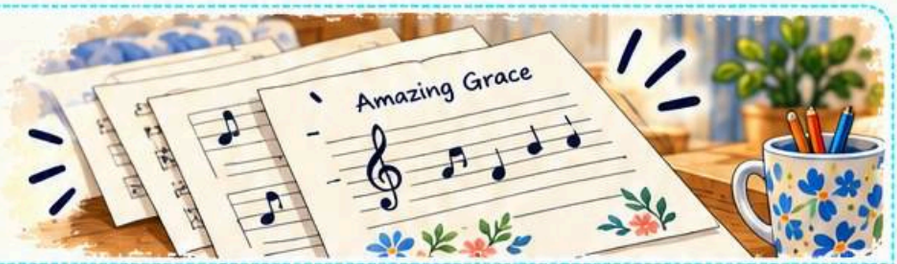


FAVORITE SONGS

- Amazing Grace
- You Are My Sunshine
- Somewhere Over the Rainbow
- Moon River
- Edelweiss
- Daisy Bell

STEP BY STEP

1. **PRINT**
   Large-print lyrics.



2. **SING**
   Slowly, together.



3. **HUM**
   Humming counts too!



CAREGIVER TIP

Spiritual songs can be very comforting for people of faith.

ACTIVITY 29 BEDSIDE & CHAIR

TABLETOP BOWLING

GAME

Strike! A bowling game that fits on a bed tray.



SCORECARD

Player	1	2	3	4	5	Total
Grandpa	2	3	1	3	2	11
Emma	1	2	4	1	3	11
Dad	0	1	2	3	2	8

STEP BY STEP



1 STACK
6 paper cups in a pyramid.



2 ROLL
A small soft ball across the tray.



3 COUNT
One point per cup.



4 RESET
Next player!

CAREGIVER TIP

Put a towel at the end of the tray so the ball doesn't fall.



ACTIVITY 30

BEDSIDE & CHAIR

THE GOOD DAY JAR

One small happy moment each day, saved forever.



CALM

GOOD DAY IDEAS

- A sunny morning
- A call from family
- A favorite song
- A good laugh

STEP BY STEP



1 WRITE
One good thing from today.



2 FOLD
Put it in the jar.



3 READ
On harder days, pick a note and read it together.

CAREGIVER TIP

Write it for them if needed. Their words, your handwriting.

You've completed all 30 activities!